

DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

Course Code: CSE0001

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Introduction

This project is part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The objective was to strengthen my skills as a Student Digital Ambassador by completing five tasks that covered awareness, professional presence, coding practice, communication etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. Each task helped me build confidence in using digital tools responsibly and professionally.

Before starting this project, I had very little knowledge about professional platforms like LinkedIn or GitHub. Working through each task has helped me understand how important it is to build a strong digital presence from the very beginning of my college journey

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used

For this task, I used **Canva**, a free and beginner-friendly design platform. Canva provided ready-made templates and icons that made it easier to create a visually appealing infographic without requiring advanced design skills.

What I Made

The infographic is titled “*What is Digital Literacy?*” and it explains the concept and importance of digital literacy. It is divided into three main sections:

1. **Useful Digital Tools** – Canva, Google Suite, Online Research
2. **Safe Internet Practices** – Secure Passwords, Avoiding Scams, Safe Browsing
3. **Email Etiquette** – Professional Tone, Clear Formatting, Proper Attachments

The design also includes illustrations of students using laptops to symbolize digital engagement, and a concluding message: “*Being digitally literate helps you navigate and succeed in an online world.*”

Reflection

While creating the infographic, I found it interesting how much information can be communicated through a single visual. The challenge was fitting all the content without making the design look cluttered. I solved this by keeping each section concise and using icons to represent ideas visually. This task taught me that digital literacy is not just about knowing tools, but also about presenting information clearly and responsibly. The infographic will help my batchmates quickly understand the importance of digital literacy and how to apply it in their daily academic and professional lives.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

For Task 2, I created my professional digital presence across three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

- **GitHub:** I set up my profile and added a README introducing myself as a B.Tech CSE (AI & ML) student. GitHub will serve as a repository for my projects, assignments, and collaborative coding work. The screenshot of my profile is included in the task-2-portfolio/ folder.
- **LinkedIn:** I updated my education section with my current degree at VIT Bhopal University. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I can connect with peers, faculty, and industry professionals. It will help me apply for internships and showcase my achievements.
- **Kaggle:** I created a Kaggle profile to practice data science and machine learning. Kaggle provides real-world datasets and competitions that will help me strengthen my AI/ML skills.

Screenshots of all three profiles are stored in the Task2 Portfolio folder of my GitHub repository.

Purpose of Each Platform

- **GitHub:** To host code, collaborate on projects, and build a portfolio of technical work.
- **LinkedIn:** To establish a professional identity, connect with recruiters, and explore career opportunities.
- **Kaggle:** To practice coding with datasets, participate in competitions, and improve machine learning expertise.

Reflection

This task taught me the importance of building a professional digital presence early in my academic career. Each platform serves a unique purpose, and together they form a strong foundation for my future opportunities. I realized that maintaining these profiles consistently will help me stand out when applying for internships and jobs.

Task 3: Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Platforms Used

For Task 3, I explored both a coding practice platform and a cloud collaboration tool.

- **HackerRank (Coding Practice):** I created an account and completed beginner-level Python challenges, including the Solve Me First problem. This helped me strengthen my programming fundamentals and gain confidence in problem-solving. Screenshots of my completed challenges and scores are included in the task-3-platforms/ folder.
- **Google Forms & Sheets (Collaboration Tools):** I designed a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz with five questions, including multiple choice and short answer formats. The form was linked to a Google Sheet to automatically collect responses, making it easy to analyze data. Screenshots of the form and the linked sheet are also stored in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

What I Built and Practised

- On **HackerRank**, I practised writing clean Python code and solving logical problems under timed conditions.
- On **Google Forms**, I built a quiz that could realistically be used to test my batchmates' awareness of digital literacy. The linked Google Sheet demonstrated how responses can be organized and analyzed efficiently.

Academic Benefits

These tools will help me in multiple ways:

- **HackerRank** will prepare me for coding interviews and improve my programming skills through regular practice.
- **Google Forms and Sheets** will support group projects, surveys, and feedback collection, making collaboration more structured and data-driven.

Reflection

This task showed me how coding platforms and collaboration tools complement each other. While HackerRank builds technical skills, Google Forms and Sheets enhance teamwork and communication. Together, they provide a strong foundation for both academic success and professional readiness.

Task 4: Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

Emails Drafted

For this task, I prepared two professional emails following proper etiquette rules.

1. Email to Professor Karan Kumar (Deadline Extension Request)

- Subject: Request for Extension on Assignment Submission
- Content: I respectfully requested an extension for the Introduction to AI/ML assignment
- The email maintained a polite tone, included a clear subject line, professional greeting, concise body, and proper sign-off with my name, registration number

2. Email to Hiring Manager (Internship Application)

- **Subject:** Application for Summer Internship Opportunity
- **Content:** I introduced myself as a B.Tech CSE (AI & ML) student from VIT Bhopal and expressed interest in summer internship opportunities. I highlighted my coursework and skills in AI/ML and requested details about the application process.

The email was structured professionally with a greeting, clear body, and formal sign-off.

Screenshots of both emails are included in the task4-email-etiquette/ folder (email1-deadline-extension.png and email2-internship.png).

Social Media Checklist

I created a **Do's and Don'ts checklist** for responsible social media use as a college student. The file (social-media-checklist.txt) is stored in the same folder.

- **Do's:** Use respectful language, verify information before sharing, maintain secure accounts, credit sources, and keep profiles professional.
- **Don'ts:** Avoid posting offensive content, sharing personal details publicly, spreading rumors, ignoring privacy settings, or engaging in online arguments.

Reflection

This task taught me the importance of clear, respectful communication in both academic and professional contexts. Poorly written emails or careless social media posts can damage relationships and reputations. For example, a student sending an email without a subject line or greeting may appear disrespectful and risk being ignored. By following etiquette rules—such as using proper salutations, concise language, and polite tone—I learned how to present myself professionally. Similarly, the social media checklist reinforced the need to maintain a positive digital footprint.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Case Study – UPI/Online Payment Fraud

For this task, I researched UPI fraud, which is one of the most common cybercrimes affecting college students in India. Attackers often pose as bank officials or customer support agents and trick victims into sharing their UPI PIN. A typical scam involves sending a fake “collect request” and convincing the victim that entering their PIN will allow them to receive money. In reality, entering the PIN always authorizes a payment, meaning money is sent out instead of received.

Students and young professionals are frequent targets because they are active users of UPI apps but may not fully understand the transaction process. The consequences include financial loss, compromised bank accounts, and emotional stress. My case study file (casestudy.md) in the repo explains this step-by-step scenario in detail.

Prevention Checklist

I created a **Stay Safe Online checklist** (prevention-checklist.md) with 8 actionable tips, including:

- Never share your UPI PIN with anyone.
- Remember: entering a UPI PIN always means sending money, not receiving.
- Verify caller identity before responding to “bank officials.”
- Avoid clicking suspicious payment links.
- Enable two-factor authentication on banking apps.
- Regularly check transaction history for unauthorized activity.
- Report fraud immediately via the **National Cyber Crime Portal** (cybercrime.gov.in). Call the 1930 helpline for urgent assistance.

Reflection

What surprised me most during this research was realizing how many students are unaware that entering a UPI PIN always authorizes a payment. This single misunderstanding is exploited by scammers repeatedly. As a personal habit change, I have decided to **never enter my UPI PIN unless I am making a payment myself** and to always double-check requests before responding.

Conclusion

Completing the Digital Literacy Portfolio has been a transformative experience that strengthened my skills as a Student Digital Ambassador. Each task contributed to a different aspect of digital literacy—awareness, professional presence, coding practice, communication etiquette, and cybercrime prevention. Together, they provided me with a holistic understanding of how to use digital tools responsibly and effectively.

I now recognize that digital literacy is not just about technical proficiency but also about professionalism, safety, and collaboration. From designing an infographic to building my online portfolio, practising coding, drafting professional emails, and researching cybercrime, I have gained practical skills that will support both my academic journey and future career. Most importantly, this project has taught me the value of maintaining a positive digital footprint and staying vigilant in the online world.

I will continue to apply these lessons by updating my professional profiles, practising coding regularly, communicating respectfully, and following safe internet practices. This project has laid a strong foundation for my growth as a responsible digital citizen and as a future professional in the field of AI and Machine Learning.

References

- Canva – canva.com (used for infographic design)
- GitHub – github.com (used for repository and profile)
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com (used for professional profile)
- Kaggle – kaggle.com (used for data science profile)
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com (used for coding practice)
- Google Forms – forms.google.com (used for quiz creation)
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in

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